Activity 4: Resilience Ecosystem After a Service Surge

Learning outcome: LO2 Objective: Redesign job demands and resources while adding proportionate resilience support Expected output: Resilience ecosystem map and a 90-day multi-level implementation plan Primary source: https://www.cipd.org/globalassets/media/knowledge/knowledge-hub/evidence-reviews/employee-resilience-discussion-report_tcm18-91717.pdf

Goal

Respond to fatigue and strain in a high-demand team without shifting responsibility onto employees to become tougher.

Real-world scenario

CIPD's evidence review treats resilience as influenced by individual and contextual factors and cautions against placing the onus on employees to withstand harmful conditions. Protective factors include self-efficacy, positive affect, social support and leader relationships; effective development tends to be structured and experiential rather than a one-off lecture.

CivicConnect, a fictional public-facing service centre, experienced a four-month demand surge. Employees report unpredictable overtime, abusive callers, low control and slow escalation. Management initially proposes a one-hour resilience webinar.

Evidence boundary

Public case facts and fictional learner data must never be mixed. Every numerical or organisational training input is labelled as an assumption.

Training assumptions / guardrails

- CivicConnect and all employee evidence are fictional training inputs.
- There is no evidence that a one-hour webinar alone will address the primary work demands.
- The operating budget allows changes to rosters, escalation, peer support and a targeted development programme.
- Any clinical support must be delivered by appropriately qualified providers.

Questions

1. Which demands are preventable, reducible or unavoidable?
2. Which resources are missing at individual, team and organisational levels?
3. What sequence balances immediate relief with sustainable redesign?
4. How will leaders know whether the change improves recovery and service?

Detailed activity procedure

Step 1: Map the employee journey

Trace a typical shift from preparation to recovery. Mark workload peaks, emotional demands, control, breaks, support and handoffs.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 2: Classify demands

Separate hindrance demands to remove, challenge demands to resource and unavoidable exposure to mitigate. Cite employee evidence for each.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 3: Map existing resources

Assess role clarity, autonomy, staffing, skills, supervisor support, peer support, recovery time and professional help.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 4: Design immediate controls

Choose actions for the next two weeks: workload triage, escalation, break protection, supervisor check-ins and post-incident support.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 5: Design systemic changes

Revise staffing, scheduling, abusive-caller policy, decision authority, queue design and manager accountability.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 6: Add capability support

Specify a structured, experiential resilience component that complements work redesign. Include practice, peer learning, coaching and referral boundaries.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 7: Plan implementation

Assign sponsor, owner, resources, consultation, communications, milestones, risks and feedback routes for 30/60/90 days.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 8: Set evaluation rules

Choose demand, resource, experience, service and safety measures. Define equity checks and a management review date.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Deliverable

Resilience ecosystem map and a 90-day multi-level implementation plan

Acceptance criteria

The plan removes or reduces at least two preventable demands, adds team and organisational resources, treats individual training as complementary, includes safe escalation and has balanced employee/service measures.

Reflection and debrief questions

1. Which assumption changed your recommendation most, and why?

2. What evidence would you request before relying on the result?
3. Which stakeholder owns the next decision or mitigation?
4. Which review trigger or future exercise should follow?

Source note

Source accessed 16 August 2026: https://www.cipd.org/globalassets/media/knowledge/knowledge-hub/evidence-reviews/employee-resilience-discussion-report_tcm18-91717.pdf